Some of the traction engines created for the innovative Chapter Challenge in 2014

How times have changed over the years – and *The Journal* has kept the IWG's members up to date

Pierce Boland demonstrating at the January workshop

an alternative venue. A number of suitable locations were identified. The Community Centre in Ballinode, a village just a few miles from Monaghan, proved to be the best option. Here the Chapter has the use of either a room – seating about 25 at a demo – or the main hall for larger numbers. The Chapter normally meets on a Saturday afternoon but can use the premises for the whole day when the need arises.

The Crossborber Chapter is relatively small and as a result it makes good use of its own members to demonstrate turning projects. However, whenever the opportunity emerges, it will have a full-day demo with visiting international demonstrators.

A larger Chapter

Although less typical of the Chapter structure, a good example of a larger grouping is the Ulster Chapter set up in 1992 and now based at the Woodshed in Templepatrick, County Antrim. It was established following the placing of an advertisement in a local paper announcing the intention to form a local Chapter of the IWG in Northern Ireland and inviting those interested to attend a meeting. Some 70 members attended and, to this day, the Ulster Chapter has remained one of the biggest Chapters of the IWG.

The normal meeting for the Chapter is 2pm to 5pm on the second Saturday of each month. There is a competition on two levels each month. Over the years the competition has helped to bring many good amateur woodturners to a higher skill level.

The Chapter has, since 2010, adopted the Play Department at the Royal Hospital for Sick Children, Belfast, as its charity producing close to 1,000 pieces of work each year. Christmas trees, snowmen, eggs, chicks and small figures are all made for the children to paint and decorate themselves. There are also some smaller items in 'safe woods' for the 'Treasure Baskets' used by the very young patients and their teachers. The Chapter is also working on establishing a twinning arrangement with Border Woodturners in Carlisle, England.

Given that Sam and Lynda Moore, proprietors of the Woodshed, host a demonstration every Tuesday night using local demonstrators the Ulster Chapter are forced to look further afield for their demonstrators. The majority of these come from across Ireland but three or four times a year the demonstrator will come from the UK which means that the demonstration will be an all-day affair. Occasionally the Chapter secretary Peter Lyons will get the opportunity to bring a demonstrator from further afield, such as the USA or continental Europe.

In such events, an Irish tour will be organised for the demonstrators to visit as many Chapters as possible in the time available. This has the combined effect of lowering the overall cost to the Ulster Chapter while simultaneously helping the smaller Chapters which benefit from being able to meet demonstrators who they could not afford to bring in on their own.

Recently, encouraged by several members, the Ulster Chapter invited Yann Marot from France to visit Ireland to do a series of masterclasses and demonstrations. This was a very successful event and Yann spent a very productive two weeks in the country, one of them in the Dublin area and the second with the Ulster Chapter.

All of the Masterclasses were fully booked and Yann also did the Tuesday-night demonstration for the Woodshed as well as a whole day for the Chapter on the Saturday. It is hoped that success of this venture will encourage more demonstrators to Ireland in the future.

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